

THE ADHD LIFE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

Complete Organization for Every Area of Life

Time | Space | Tasks | Money | Relationships

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Designed specifically for how ADHD brains actually work.

WHY TRADITIONAL SYSTEMS FAIL ADHD BRAINS

Traditional planners assume you have:

- Consistent working memory (you don't)
- Natural sense of time passing (you don't)
- Automatic prioritization (you don't)
- Built-in reward for boring tasks (you don't)
- Ability to 'just start' (executive dysfunction is real)

This system is different because:

- Visual over text-heavy
- External structure replaces internal executive function
- Dopamine-friendly rewards built in
- Accommodates hyperfocus AND low-energy days
- No guilt, no 'catching up' - fresh starts daily
- Combines ALL life areas so nothing falls through cracks

The 5-System Approach:

1. TIME - External clocks for internal time blindness
2. SPACE - Visual systems for out-of-sight-out-of-mind
3. TASKS - Energy-matched, dopamine-paired action lists
4. MONEY - Autopilot finances with impulse guardrails
5. RELATIONSHIPS - Social energy budgets and scripts

SYSTEM 1: TIME MANAGEMENT

BODY DOUBLING PLANNER

Body doubling = having someone present while you work.

My body doubling options:

In-person: _____

Virtual: _____

Apps/videos: _____

Tasks that need body doubling:

Schedule: Mon ____ Tue ____ Wed ____ Thu ____ Fri ____

SYSTEM 1: TIME MANAGEMENT
TIME BLINDNESS TOOLS

My time estimation practice:

Task: _____ Estimated: ____ Actual: ____

Task: _____ Estimated: ____ Actual: ____

Task: _____ Estimated: ____ Actual: ____

Task: _____ Estimated: ____ Actual: ____

Rule: Multiply my estimate by ____ (usually 2-3x)

Visual timers I use: _____

Alarms set for: _____

SYSTEM 1: TIME MANAGEMENT

TRANSITION WARNINGS

Transitions are HARD. Plan for them.

Morning transition (bed to productive):

10-min warning: ____ 5-min: ____ Action: ____

Task-to-task transition:

What helps me switch: _____

Leaving the house transition:

Items needed (by door): _____

Time buffer added: ____ minutes

Bedtime transition (screen to sleep):

Wind-down routine: _____

SYSTEM 1: TIME MANAGEMENT

TIME BLOCKING (ADHD Style)

Theme days work better than hourly blocks.

Monday theme: _____

Tuesday theme: _____

Wednesday theme: _____

Thursday theme: _____

Friday theme: _____

Non-negotiable anchors (things that MUST happen):

Morning anchor: _____

Afternoon anchor: _____

Evening anchor: _____

SYSTEM 1: TIME MANAGEMENT

HYPERFOCUS MANAGEMENT

Hyperfocus is a SUPERPOWER when directed.

My hyperfocus triggers: _____

Topics I easily hyperfocus on: _____

Guardrails for unproductive hyperfocus:

Timer set for: ____ hours

Check-in alarm every: ____ minutes

Accountability partner to text: _____

Directing hyperfocus productively:

Project to channel it into: _____

Best time of day for deep work: _____

Environment that supports focus: _____

SYSTEM 2: SPACE

DUMP ZONES

Designated spots where stuff lands. Not mess - systems.

Entry dump zone (keys/wallet/bag): _____

Kitchen dump zone (mail/papers): _____

Bedroom dump zone (clothes): _____

Work dump zone (projects): _____

Weekly dump zone reset day: _____

Time needed: ____ minutes

SYSTEM 2: SPACE

LAUNCHING PADS

Everything you need to leave = one spot.

Morning launch pad location: _____

Items always there: _____

Work launch pad: _____

Gym launch pad: _____

Errands launch pad: _____

SYSTEM 2: SPACE

VISUAL CUES

If you can't see it, it doesn't exist.

Clear containers for: _____

Open shelving for: _____

Whiteboard locations: _____

Sticky note stations: _____

Color coding system:

Red = _____ Blue = _____

Green = _____ Yellow = _____

SYSTEM 2: SPACE

15-MINUTE ROOM RESETS

Set timer. Do what you can. STOP when it rings.

Kitchen reset (15 min): dishes, counters, floor

Bedroom reset (15 min): bed, clothes, surfaces

Bathroom reset (15 min): counter, toilet, floor

Living room reset (15 min): surfaces, pillows, trash

My reset schedule:

Mon: _____ Tue: _____ Wed: _____

Thu: _____ Fri: _____ Sat: _____

SYSTEM 2: SPACE

ORGANIZATION THAT WORKS

Simple = sustainable for ADHD.

Rules: 1 touch (handle it once), visible, labeled, easy

Area 1: _____ System: _____

Area 2: _____ System: _____

Area 3: _____ System: _____

Things I will NEVER organize perfectly (let go):

Good enough = _____

SYSTEM 3: TASKS

2-MINUTE RULE

If it takes less than 2 minutes, do it NOW.

2-minute tasks I keep putting off:

My 2-minute wins today:

SYSTEM 3: TASKS

CONTEXT LISTS

Group tasks by WHERE/WHEN, not priority.

At Computer: _____

On Phone: _____

At Store: _____

With Energy: _____

Low Energy: _____

SYSTEM 3: TASKS

ENERGY MATCHING

Match task difficulty to energy level.

HIGH energy tasks: _____

MEDIUM energy tasks: _____

LOW energy (zombie mode) tasks: _____

My energy pattern: Morning=___ Afternoon=___ Evening=___

SYSTEM 3: TASKS

REWARD PAIRING

Pair boring tasks with dopamine.

Task: _____ + Reward: _____

Task: _____ + Reward: _____

Task: _____ + Reward: _____

Task: _____ + Reward: _____

My dopamine menu (healthy rewards):

5-min rewards: _____

15-min rewards: _____

Big rewards: _____

SYSTEM 3: TASKS

GETTING UNSTUCK

When executive dysfunction hits:

- ☐ Change environment (move to different room)
- ☐ Make task smaller (what's the TINIEST first step?)
- ☐ Body double (get someone present)
- ☐ Set timer for just 5 minutes
- ☐ Pair with music/podcast
- ☐ Use countdown (5-4-3-2-1-GO)
- ☐ Change the task (do something else productive)
- ☐ Accept: today is not the day (self-compassion)

My personal unstuck tricks:

SYSTEM 4: MONEY

AUTO-PILOT FINANCES

Remove decisions. Automate everything.

Auto-pay bills (list all): _____

Auto-transfer to savings: \$____ on ____th

Auto-transfer to fun money: \$____ on ____th

Accounts:

Checking (bills): _____

Savings (emergency): _____

Fun money (impulsive spending): _____

SYSTEM 4: MONEY
IMPULSE PAUSE

ADHD brains seek novelty. Impulse spending is dopamine.

My impulse spending triggers: _____

The 48-Hour Rule: Want it? Wait 48 hours. Still want it?

Item: _____ Date wanted: ____ Still want on ____? Y/N

Item: _____ Date wanted: ____ Still want on ____? Y/N

Item: _____ Date wanted: ____ Still want on ____? Y/N

Item: _____ Date wanted: ____ Still want on ____? Y/N

Monthly impulse budget (guilt-free): \$____

SYSTEM 4: MONEY

BILL VISUAL CALENDAR

If it's not visible, it won't get paid.

1st: _____ \$ ____	16th: _____ \$ ____
2nd: _____ \$ ____	17th: _____ \$ ____
5th: _____ \$ ____	20th: _____ \$ ____
8th: _____ \$ ____	22nd: _____ \$ ____
10th: _____ \$ ____	25th: _____ \$ ____
12th: _____ \$ ____	28th: _____ \$ ____
15th: _____ \$ ____	30th: _____ \$ ____

Total monthly bills: \$ ____

Income: \$ ____ Remaining: \$ ____

SYSTEM 4: MONEY

MONEY FEELINGS

ADHD + money shame = avoidance. Break the cycle.

My money story: _____

Shame triggers: _____

When I avoid finances, it's because: _____

Small money wins this week:

☐ Checked bank balance

☐ Paid one bill

☐ Said no to one purchase

☐ Moved \$1 to savings

Affirmation: I am learning. Progress, not perfection.

SYSTEM 4: MONEY

SUBSCRIPTION AUDIT

Monthly subscriptions add up invisibly.

Subscription: _____ \$____/mo Keep? Y/N

Subscription: _____ \$____/mo Keep? Y/N

Subscription: _____ \$____/mo Keep? Y/N

Subscription: _____ \$____/mo Keep? Y/N

Subscription: _____ \$____/mo Keep? Y/N

Subscription: _____ \$____/mo Keep? Y/N

Subscription: _____ \$____/mo Keep? Y/N

Subscription: _____ \$____/mo Keep? Y/N

Total: \$____/mo = \$____/year

After audit: \$____/mo = \$____/year Saved: \$____

SYSTEM 5: RELATIONSHIPS

SOCIAL ENERGY BUDGET

Social interaction costs energy. Budget it.

My social battery capacity (1-10): ____

Low-cost interactions: _____

Medium-cost: _____

High-cost (draining): _____

This week's social budget:

Mon: ____ Tue: ____ Wed: ____ Thu: ____ Fri: ____

Planned recovery time: _____

SYSTEM 5: RELATIONSHIPS

COMMUNICATION TEMPLATES

Pre-written scripts reduce executive load.

Running late: 'Hey! Running about ____ minutes late. So sorry!'

Canceling: 'I need to reschedule. Can we do ____?'

Saying no: 'I appreciate you thinking of me. I can't this time.'

Apologizing: 'I'm sorry I _____. I should have _____.'

Asking for help: 'I'm struggling with _____. Could you _____?'

My custom scripts:

SYSTEM 5: RELATIONSHIPS

APOLOGY SCRIPTS

ADHD means more apologies. Have them ready.

For forgetting: 'I'm sorry I forgot _____. It's not that I don't care - my brain dropped it. How can I make it up to you?'

For being late: 'I'm sorry for being late. I know your time matters. I'm working on systems to be more punctual.'

For interrupting: 'I'm sorry I interrupted. I got excited. Please continue - I want to hear what you were saying.'

For zoning out: 'I'm sorry, I drifted. Can you repeat that? I want to give you my full attention.'

My personalized apology:

SYSTEM 5: RELATIONSHIPS

RELATIONSHIP MAINTENANCE

Relationships need proactive maintenance.

Key people & check-in schedule:

_____ : Every ____ days Last: ____/____

_____ : Every ____ days Last: ____/____

_____ : Every ____ days Last: ____/____

_____ : Every ____ days Last: ____/____

_____ : Every ____ days Last: ____/____

Phone reminders set? ☐ Yes

Calendar blocks for social time? ☐ Yes

SYSTEM 5: RELATIONSHIPS

EXPLAINING ADHD TO OTHERS

Not excuses - education.

To my partner: 'When I ____, it's because my brain ____.

What would help us both is ____.'

To my boss: 'I work best when _____. Could we _____?'

To friends: 'I might forget to text back. It's not personal.

Please don't stop inviting me.'

My ADHD strengths to share:

Accommodations I need:

DAILY PAGE - DAY 1

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ **Done?** ☐

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: ☐ _____

Med energy: ☐ _____

Low energy: ☐ _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? ☐ **Impulse resisted?** ☐

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 2

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ **Done?** ☐

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: ☐ _____

Med energy: ☐ _____

Low energy: ☐ _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? ☐ **Impulse resisted?** ☐

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 3

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ Done? []

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: [] _____

Med energy: [] _____

Low energy: [] _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? [] Impulse resisted? []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 4

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ Done? []

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: [] _____

Med energy: [] _____

Low energy: [] _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? [] Impulse resisted? []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 5

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ **Done?** []

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: [] _____

Med energy: [] _____

Low energy: [] _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? [] **Impulse resisted?** []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 6

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ **Done?** ☐

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: ☐ _____

Med energy: ☐ _____

Low energy: ☐ _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? ☐ **Impulse resisted?** ☐

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 7

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ Done? []

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: [] _____

Med energy: [] _____

Low energy: [] _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? [] Impulse resisted? []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 8

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ **Done?** []

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: [] _____

Med energy: [] _____

Low energy: [] _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? [] **Impulse resisted?** []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 9

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ **Done?** ☐

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: ☐ _____

Med energy: ☐ _____

Low energy: ☐ _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? ☐ **Impulse resisted?** ☐

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

DAILY PAGE - DAY 10

Date: ____/____/____ Energy level: ____/10

TIME: Today's non-negotiable anchors:

Morning: _____ Afternoon: _____ Evening: _____

SPACE: 15-min reset target room: _____ **Done?** []

TASKS (energy-matched):

High energy: [] _____

Med energy: [] _____

Low energy: [] _____

MONEY: Did I check balance? [] **Impulse resisted?** []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connection made today: _____

Reward earned: _____

Tomorrow's #1 priority: _____

WEEKLY REVIEW - WEEK 1

TIME: Transition successes: _____

TIME: Where I lost time: _____

SPACE: Rooms reset this week: _____

TASKS: Completed: ____ / ____ Biggest win: _____

MONEY: Budget on track? [] Impulses managed? []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connections made: _____

What worked this week: _____

What to adjust: _____

Self-compassion note: _____

Next week's focus: _____

WEEKLY REVIEW - WEEK 2

TIME: Transition successes: _____

TIME: Where I lost time: _____

SPACE: Rooms reset this week: _____

TASKS: Completed: ____ / ____ Biggest win: _____

MONEY: Budget on track? [] Impulses managed? []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connections made: _____

What worked this week: _____

What to adjust: _____

Self-compassion note: _____

Next week's focus: _____

WEEKLY REVIEW - WEEK 3

TIME: Transition successes: _____

TIME: Where I lost time: _____

SPACE: Rooms reset this week: _____

TASKS: Completed: ____ / ____ Biggest win: _____

MONEY: Budget on track? [] Impulses managed? []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connections made: _____

What worked this week: _____

What to adjust: _____

Self-compassion note: _____

Next week's focus: _____

WEEKLY REVIEW - WEEK 4

TIME: Transition successes: _____

TIME: Where I lost time: _____

SPACE: Rooms reset this week: _____

TASKS: Completed: ____ / ____ Biggest win: _____

MONEY: Budget on track? [] Impulses managed? []

RELATIONSHIPS: Connections made: _____

What worked this week: _____

What to adjust: _____

Self-compassion note: _____

Next week's focus: _____

MONTHLY RESET CHECKLIST

- ☐ Review & update all auto-pays
- ☐ Check subscriptions - cancel unused
- ☐ Deep clean one dump zone
- ☐ Update context lists
- ☐ Check in with 3 important people
- ☐ Review time estimates - adjust multiplier
- ☐ Celebrate 3 wins from this month
- ☐ Set next month's theme days
- ☐ Restock launch pads
- ☐ Update visual calendar
- ☐ Body doubling schedule confirmed
- ☐ Rewards menu refreshed

MY PERSONALIZED ADHD MANUAL

My ADHD type/profile: _____

Medication (if applicable): _____

Best time of day for focus: _____

Worst time (don't schedule hard things): _____

My top 3 strengths: _____

My top 3 challenges: _____

What recharges me: _____

What drains me: _____

Accommodations that help:

My ADHD-friendly systems that work:

When I'm struggling, I will:

I am not broken. I am differently wired. My ADHD is also my:
